

Newsletter Audit

Marketing emails, 1 Oct 2025 – 30 Sep 2026 · Source: HubSpot, 8 Oct 2026

3/10

HubSpot email health score

Last 30 days · "Needs work"

3.26%

Click rate

1,028,641 emails sent

0.81%

Unsubscribe rate

+72% vs previous 12 months

1.29%

Hard bounce rate

+97% vs previous 12 months

● What's flagged

Hard bounces: 2.54% in the last 30 days. HubSpot benchmark: 0.25%. **Unsubscribes:** 1.04%. HubSpot benchmark: 0.35%.

3 emails sent in Aug–Sep 2026 (Japan Sansan list consent mail, Corporate Partnership Survey 3rd batch, Alibaba CoCreate startup email) caused **47% of unsubscribes** and **74% of bounces** (83% of hard bounces) of all emails sent 1 Aug – 30 Sep.

Marketing contacts: 590,458, which is 93.7% of the 630,000 tier. 433,657 have never opened a marketing email. → Appendix 1

Location data: the contact "Location" property is empty or "N/A" for 96% of marketing contacts (567,855 of 590,464).

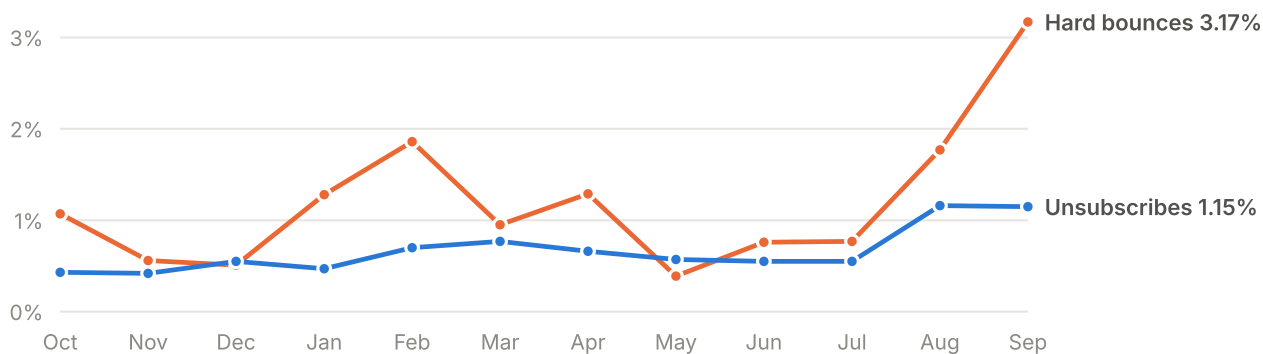
Subscription types: 20 of the 40 newsletter series were sent under "Marketing Communications" at least once. → Appendix 2

HR emails: 232 of the 1,063 marketing emails were HR birthday / work-anniversary emails.

Tracking: unsubscribe survey off (no unsubscribe reasons). None of the emails has a team assigned. 65 email workflows are ON and not updated since before 2024. → Appendix 3

Hard bounces and unsubscribes by month (HubSpot Health tab)

Hard bounces Unsubscribes



● What's working

Japan newsletter: 23 sends (every 2 weeks), 4.6% click rate, 0.20% unsubscribes, under its own subscription type.

APAC newsletter: 10 sends, 2.3% click rate, 0.37% unsubscribes, under its own subscription type.

Smaller sends: emails to fewer than 300 people (HR emails excluded) averaged a 9.0% click rate and 0.36% unsubscribes. Emails to 5,000+ people averaged 1.6% and 1.04%.

Spam reports: 0.01%. **Delivery rate:** 98.3%. **"Don't send to unengaged contacts"** is on.

● What can be improved

Low clicks, high unsubscribes: UK (1.0% click, 0.96% unsubscribes), Italy (1.4%, 0.87%), Fintech & AI Insights (0.7%, 1.39%).

Location newsletters moved to one shared subscription type: UK, Italy, Türkiye and Central Asia & Caucasus switched from their own type to "Marketing Communications" between Jan and Feb 2026. Texas and Indiana used it from their first send. → [Appendix 2](#)

Engagement: 81,646 of 590,458 marketing contacts (13.8%) opened or clicked an email in the last 12 months. → [Appendix 1](#)

Campaigns: 787 of 1,063 emails have no campaign. 61 of 78 campaigns have no start or end date.

Recurring newsletters with 2,000+ recipients per send (12 months)

Red = above HubSpot's unsubscribe benchmark (0.35%). * = sent under "Marketing Communications" at least once.

Newsletter	Sends	Avg. delivered	Click rate	Unsubscribe rate
Global Newsletter (GNL)	12	8,225	2.0%	0.60%
Sustainable Future Newsletter *	4	5,874	1.2%	0.77%
UK Newsletter *	12	4,978	1.0%	0.96%
Fintech & AI Fund Insights	2	4,858	0.7%	1.39%
Texas Newsletter *	6	4,849	3.0%	0.91%
Italy Newsletter *	12	3,873	1.4%	0.87%
Startup Autobahn – Monthly Dose of Tech Inspiration	7	3,644	3.1%	0.39%
Smart Cities Newsletter *	2	3,164	1.6%	0.85%
Global Travel & Hospitality Newsletter *	3	2,993	1.3%	0.61%
APAC Newsletter	10	2,933	2.3%	0.38%
Arizona Monthly eBlast	5	2,846	1.9%	0.52%
Health Newsletter *	3	2,751	1.1%	0.48%
APAC Ventures Wrap-Up	2	2,727	2.5%	0.31%
Financial Services Newsletter *	2	2,560	0.9%	0.92%
Central Asia & Caucasus Newsletter *	7	2,506	1.9%	1.24%
Japan Newsletter	23	2,127	4.6%	0.20%

Who sends recurring newsletters

39 newsletters (internal newsletter not shown): 16 monthly, 11 quarterly, 4 every 2 months, 2 weekly, 1 every 2 weeks, 2 twice a year, 2 new, 1 once.

"How often" = median days between sends (sends within 3 days count as one). ● = no send since June 2026. Red = "Marketing Communications" (Mkt Comms); "→ Mkt Comms" = moved to it from another type. +n = more senders.

Newsletter	Sender (From name)	How often	Sends	Last sent	Subscription type
Global (1)					
Global Newsletter (GNL)	Jacky	Monthly	12	29 Sep 26	Global Newsletter
Location newsletters (15)					
UK Newsletter	Kieran Borrett	Monthly	12	30 Sep 26	→ Mkt Comms
Texas Newsletter	Francis	Monthly	6	29 Sep 26	Mkt Comms
Italy Newsletter	Tommaso Maschera	Monthly	12	17 Sep 26	→ Mkt Comms
APAC Newsletter	Plug and Play APAC	Monthly	10	22 Sep 26	APAC
Arizona Monthly eBlast	Plug and Play Arizona	Monthly	5	30 Mar 26 ●	Events
APAC Ventures Wrap-Up	James Conde	Quarterly	2	8 Jul 26	APAC
Central Asia & Caucasus Newsletter	Gohar Central Asia an...	Every 2 months	7	4 Sep 26	→ Mkt Comms
Japan Newsletter	Plug and Play Japan	Every 2 weeks	23	30 Sep 26	Japan
Seattle Community Newsletter	Emmanuel Chan +1	Monthly	9	1 Sep 26	→ Mkt Comms
Indiana Medtech + Lifetech Newsletter	Eileen Alberding +1	Monthly	7	18 Sep 26	Mkt Comms
Türkiye Newsletter	Zeynep	Monthly	12	30 Sep 26	→ Mkt Comms
Medtech Community Newsletter	Eileen Alberding	Monthly	4	14 Jan 26 ●	Warsaw
Cambodia Newsletter	Plug and Play APAC	Every 2 months	2	23 Jun 26 ●	APAC
Lifetech Community Newsletter	Eileen Alberding	Monthly	2	15 Dec 25 ●	Indiana
Vienna Recap	Plug and Play Vienna	Quarterly	4	7 Jul 26	→ Mkt Comms
Industry newsletters (9)					
Enterprise & AI Newsletter	Amit	Once	1	28 Apr 26 ●	Mkt Comms
Sustainable Future Newsletter	Robert Grey	Quarterly	4	23 Jul 26	Mkt Comms
Fintech & AI Fund Insights	Brooke Ballinger	New (Aug–Se...	2	23 Sep 26	Fintech & AI Fund In...
Smart Cities Newsletter	Angie +1	Twice a year	2	24 Jun 26 ●	Mkt Comms
Global Travel & Hospitality Newsletter	Christina +1	Quarterly	3	6 Jul 26	→ Mkt Comms
Health Newsletter	Ayah	Quarterly	3	1 Jul 26	Mkt Comms
Financial Services Newsletter	Davis Auksmuksts	Quarterly	2	13 Jul 26	Mkt Comms
Brand & Retail (BRAM) Newsletter	Plug and Play Brand a...	New (Aug–Se...	2	29 Sep 26	Brand and Retail team
Supply Chain – SLAM Innovation Brief	Plug and Play Supply ...	Monthly	3	8 Sep 26	Information & Services
Program newsletters (6)					
Startup Autobahn – Monthly Dose of Te...	Startup Autobahn	Monthly	7	6 Sep 26	Startup Autobahn C...
Foundation Newsletter	Dominique Reese	Monthly	4	18 Aug 26	Foundation
Startup Autobahn Alumni Newsletter	Startup Autobahn	Every 2 months	2	11 Aug 26	Startup Autobahn C...
UK Mobilise Monthly Update	Adam McGuinness	Monthly	7	3 Sep 26	Events
Indianapolis Lifetech Batch Newsletter	Eileen Alberding +2	Weekly	11	12 Feb 26 ●	→ Mkt Comms
Warsaw Medtech Batch Newsletter	Plug and Play Medtec...	Weekly	24	23 Jul 26	→ Mkt Comms
Mentor & alumni newsletters (8)					
AgTech & Animal Health Alumni/Mentor ...	Anne Gunden	Quarterly	4	26 Aug 26	→ Mkt Comms
Medtech Alumni Newsletter	Eileen Alberding +1	Quarterly	3	15 Jul 26	→ Mkt Comms
Medtech Mentor Newsletter	Eileen Alberding +1	Quarterly	3	15 Jul 26	→ Mkt Comms
Travel Mentor Newsletter	Curtis Chan +1	Quarterly	2	27 Mar 26 ●	→ Mkt Comms
Brand & Retail Mentor Newsletter	Sophia Nguyen	Every 2 months	2	2 Dec 25 ●	Brand & Retail Ment...
Lifetech Mentor Newsletter	Eileen Alberding	Monthly	2	8 Jan 26 ●	Indiana
NMP Mentor Newsletter	Tabitha Mills	Twice a year	2	3 Sep 26	Global Newsletter
Minnesota Sustainability Mentor Newsl...	Tabitha Mills	Quarterly	3	3 Sep 26	Global Newsletter

Email activity by location

Location / program	Emails	Recurring newsletters	Click rate	Last email	Own subscription type
Silicon Valley (HQ)	122	1	3.3%	30 Sep 26	Global Newsletter (active)
Indiana (Indianapolis / Warsaw IN)	99	8	5.1%	18 Sep 26	Archived
APAC	93	3	3.4%	22 Sep 26	Active
Japan	62	1	2.8%	30 Sep 26	Active
UK	35	2	1.2%	30 Sep 26	Archived
Central Asia & Caucasus	34	1	3.3%	4 Sep 26	Archived
Minnesota	31	2	6.0%	14 Sep 26	None
Germany	31	2	4.0%	6 Sep 26	Archived (Startup Autobahn: active)
Italy	26	1	3.0%	17 Sep 26	Archived
Nordics (Finland / Sweden)	20	0	9.5%	28 Sep 26	None
Supply Chain (program)	18	1	4.8%	14 Sep 26	Archived
Lithuania	17	0	4.2%	1 Jun 26 ●	Archived
Texas	15	1	3.2%	29 Sep 26	Archived
Austria (Vienna)	14	1	7.6%	7 Jul 26	Archived
Albania	13	0	11.0%	30 Sep 26	None
Türkiye	13	1	1.9%	30 Sep 26	Archived
Florida (Orlando / NeoCity)	11	0	5.2%	16 Jul 26	Archived
France	11	0	4.0%	8 Sep 26	Archived
Seattle	10	1	4.1%	1 Sep 26	Archived
Middle East & Africa	9	0	2.0%	23 Sep 26	Archived
Spain	7	0	4.8%	22 Jan 26 ●	Archived
Arizona	5	1	1.9%	30 Mar 26 ●	Archived
Brand & Retail (program)	5	2	5.0%	29 Sep 26	Active
Foundation	5	1	2.4%	18 Aug 26	Active
AgTech (program)	4	1	2.6%	26 Aug 26	Archived
Cyprus	4	0	2.2%	28 Sep 26	None
Travel (program)	2	1	9.1%	27 Mar 26 ●	Archived (Travel & Hospitality SV: active)
Canada	1	0	1.8%	7 Jan 26 ●	Archived

● = no email since June 2026. Also sent: Internal / HR 248, industry newsletters 25, global content (CDW) 23, location not identifiable 50.

HubSpot teams whose location is not named in any email: Amsterdam, Basel, Brazil, LATAM, Cleveland, Savannah, South Africa, Egypt.

"Plug and Play Los Angeles" (active subscription type) was used by 1 email in the period.

Contact Location property: empty or "N/A" for 96% of marketing contacts.

Vertical newsletter performance

Newsletter	Sender	How often	Sends	Last sent	Avg. delivered	Click	Unsub
Enterprise & AI Newsletter	Amit from Plug and Play	Once	1	28 Apr 26	6,533	1.5%	1.26%
Sustainable Future Newsletter	Robert Grey	Quarterly	4	23 Jul 26	5,874	1.2%	0.77%
Fintech & AI Fund Insights	Brooke Ballinger	New (started Aug-Sep 2026)	2	23 Sep 26	4,858	0.7%	1.39%
Smart Cities Newsletter	Angie from Plug and Play, Sobhan Khani	Twice a year	2	24 Jun 26	3,164	1.6%	0.85%
Global Travel & Hospitality Newsletter	Christina from Plug and Play, Plug and Play Vienna	Quarterly	3	6 Jul 26	2,993	1.3%	0.61%
Health Newsletter	Ayah from Plug and Play	Quarterly	3	1 Jul 26	2,751	1.1%	0.48%
Financial Services Newsletter	Davis Auksmuksts	Quarterly	2	13 Jul 26	2,560	0.9%	0.92%
Brand & Retail (BRAM) Newsletter	Plug and Play Brand and Retail	New (started Aug-Sep 2026)	2	29 Sep 26	190	3.2%	0.53%
Supply Chain – SLAM Innovation Brief	Plug and Play Supply Chain	Monthly	3	8 Sep 26	49	9.6%	0.00%

Red = above HubSpot's unsubscribe benchmark (0.35%).

Campaign: 8 of these emails sit in "MKT_Industry Newsletters 2026".

Subscription types: 14 vertical newsletter types are archived (Health, Deeptech, Smart Cities, Sustainability, Travel, ...). Six industry newsletters were sent under "Marketing Communications".

Contact data: the "Vertical" property is filled for 60,146 marketing contacts (10.2%); "Newsletter_Subscription_All verticals" for 3,181 (0.5%).

● Possible next steps

- 1 **Imported lists:** validate large imported lists before sending, and send a test batch first.
- 2 **Inactive contacts:** review the 433,657 marketing contacts who have never opened an email, and decide whether to set them as non-marketing.
- 3 **Subscription types:** give each location and industry newsletter its own type again, as Japan and APAC have.
- 4 **Newsletter owners:** confirm the owner and frequency of each newsletter in the newsletter map, including the ones with no send since June 2026.
- 5 **Location data:** fill the contact "Location" property, so lists and reports can be built by location.
- 6 **Teams, naming and campaigns:** assign a team and a campaign to every email and use one naming format.
- 7 **Unsubscribe survey:** switch it on.
- 8 **HR emails and workflows:** review whether HR emails belong in marketing email, and review the 65 old workflows with their owners.
- 9 **Re-check in 90 days:** health score, bounces, unsubscribes and marketing contacts.

Sources: HubSpot Analyze export, Health tab, email export (1,063 published emails) and contact counts, 8 Oct 2026. Full data: *PNP_HubSpot_Newsletter_Audit.xlsx*.

Marketing contacts who don't engage

Measure	Contacts	% of marketing contacts
Marketing contacts (Marketing contact status = Marketing contact)	590,458	100%
Marketing contact tier (Settings > Account & Billing > Usage)	630,000	–
No marketing email open or click in the last 12 months (never opened/clicked included)	508,812	86.2%
Never opened a marketing email	433,657	73.4%
Opened or clicked in the last 12 months	81,646	13.8%

Tier usage: 93.7% used (39,542 contacts left). Next update: 31 Oct 2026. 454 contacts are already scheduled to become non-marketing.

Billing: HubSpot bills by marketing contacts. Non-marketing contacts stay in the CRM and don't count toward the tier ([HubSpot Knowledge Base](#)).

Note: "Never opened" includes contacts added recently.

Source: HubSpot contact counts and Usage page, 8 Oct 2026.

Location newsletters and subscription types

Newsletter	Subscription type used (sends)	Period
UK Newsletter	Plug and Play UK Communications (3)	Oct 25 – Nov 25
	Plug and Play Marketing Communications (9)	Jan 26 – Sep 26
Italy Newsletter	Plug and Play Italy (5)	Oct 25 – Jan 26
	Plug and Play Marketing Communications (8)	Feb 26 – Sep 26
Türkiye Newsletter	Plug and Play Istanbul Communications (4)	Oct 25 – Jan 26
	Plug and Play Marketing Communications (8)	Feb 26 – Sep 26
Central Asia & Caucasus Newsletter	Plug and Play Central Asia & Caucasus (2)	Oct 25 – Dec 25
	Plug and Play Marketing Communications (7)	Feb 26 – Sep 26
Seattle Community Newsletter	Enterprise & AI Newsletter (4)	Oct 25 – Jan 26
	Plug and Play Marketing Communications (5)	Mar 26 – Sep 26
Texas Newsletter	Plug and Play Marketing Communications (6)	Feb 26 – Sep 26
Indiana Medtech + Lifetech Newsletter	Plug and Play Marketing Communications (7)	Feb 26 – Sep 26
Japan Newsletter	Plug and Play Japan (23)	Oct 25 – Sep 26
APAC Newsletter	Plug and Play APAC (10)	Nov 25 – Sep 26

Location subscription types in HubSpot

Location	Subscription type	Status
UK	Plug and Play UK Communications	Archived
Texas	Plug and Play Texas	Archived
Italy	Plug and Play Italy (2 types)	Archived
Seattle	Plug and Play Seattle	Archived
Indiana	Plug and Play Indiana	Archived
Türkiye	Plug and Play Istanbul Communications	Archived
Central Asia	Plug and Play Central Asia & Caucasus	Archived
Cyprus	None	–

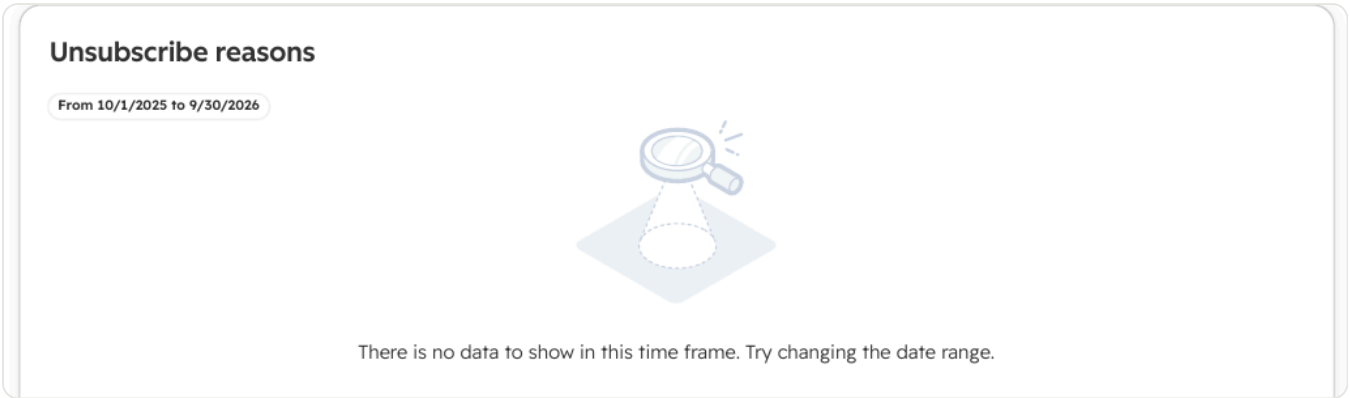
Unsubscribing from "Marketing Communications" stops **every email sent under that type**, including all the location newsletters above that use it.

Other subscription types (e.g. Global Newsletter, Events, Japan) are not affected, unless the contact unsubscribes from all.

Source: HubSpot email export and Settings > Marketing > Email > Subscriptions, 8 Oct 2026.

Tracking and automation

Unsubscribe reasons: no data



HubSpot Analyze export, 1 Oct 2025 – 30 Sep 2026. Setting "Unsubscribe feedback survey": OFF.

Teams

None of the 1,042 emails sent has a team assigned. HubSpot has 62 teams set up (e.g. Japan 32 users, Marketing 15, APAC 5, London 3).

Workflows with a "Send email" action

Total	309	
ON	251	
OFF	58	
ON and last updated before 2024 (oldest: 5 Oct 2020)	65	
ON, with "COVID" in the name	Last updated	Currently enrolled
JAP_eBook_COVID-19	2024-09-04	0
TVL_Ebook_Rebooting Travel after COVID-19	2023-06-29	0
PNP_World After COVID_Ebook Download	2023-06-29	0
SMC_Ebook_Rethinking Smart Cities after COVID-19	2022-12-27	0
HTH_Ebook_Top Health Startups fighting COVID-19	2021-02-17	0

Full list of the 65 workflows: spreadsheet, tab "Old Workflows". Source: HubSpot > Automation > Workflows, 8 Oct 2026.